



Liberia National ECD Curriculum: Teacher Planner

3- to 6-Year-Olds

STAYING HEALTHY AND SAFE: December



Ministry of Education / Bureau of Early Childhood Education

2017

INTRODUCTION TO STAYING HEALTHY AND SAFE

“Staying Healthy and Safe” is planned for one month approximately – **December**. Each of the sections might last one or two weeks depending on the interest of children.

Staying Healthy and Safe

I.		Keeping My Body Healthy	2 weeks 1
II.		Caring for Our Community	2 week 25



I: KEEPING MY BODY HEALTHY

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

According to Liberian professionals, health is being well in body and mind, getting along with others, and eating healthy food.

During the preschool years children become very aware of their bodies, how they are growing, the differences between boys and girls, sickness and wellness. Children have many questions, concerns and worries about their physical health. They need information given to them in simple terms so they can begin to understand how to take care of themselves. Life-long habits are being formed at this age. Eating healthy food, exercising, and good personal hygiene habits all need to be encouraged.

Children need to understand when they need to rest, when they are not feeling well and why they may need to see a doctor. Children need to know when to tell an adult about how their body feels. Children need to be aware of what is good to put in their mouth and what may cause them harm. Children have concerns and issues about their health and the health of others they love. Many medical procedures are scary to them. Children need to talk about their feelings and concerns, act them out in the dramatic play area and draw them in pictures.

The teacher's role is also to model behavior that promotes health. Children watch adults and learn from and imitate their actions. It is important that teachers eat the foods that are served for snack and lunch, exercise with the children and model personal hygiene habits for the children. Parents need to model these healthy behaviors, too. Teachers need to invite parents to join in health activities and be sure parents are aware of the classroom activities so they can be reinforced at home.

The activities in this section focus on personal hygiene and health habits in the classroom. Colds and germs spread quickly in a classroom and it is important for children to know how to wash their hands and blow their noses correctly so the whole class stays healthy. These activities can be shared with parents and practiced at home. Other activities include exercise, information on poisons and discussions and role playing about being ill. These are only a few samples of activities that can be done with children to promote awareness of their physical bodies and their health. Other components of physical health that teachers and parents may want to explore include: height and weight; dental care; taking medicine; bathing, relaxing, and using seat belts.



WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – December, Week 1

I: Keeping My Body Healthy

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Handwashing	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Keeping Healthy	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Being sick and well	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Exercise Is Healthy	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Safety in the streets
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child's choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups	Handwashing	What goes in my mouth?	Being sick and well	Nose Blowing	No Small Groups
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Water Play	Free Play	Water Play	Sand Play	
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.45 – 14.15	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can't sleep may "read" books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children's books related to the topic.				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				

Activities with Parents throughout the day	- Parents can volunteer in Small Group activities - Parents can join in songs, games, books, storytelling - Parents can learn an activity and practice at home
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WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – December, Week 2

I: My Body

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Handwashing	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Keeping Healthy	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Brushing Teeth	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Exercise Us Healthy	- Welcome children - Greetings - What is the topic for the week? - Safety in the streets
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child's choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups	Handwashing	What goes in my mouth	Handwashing	Nose Blowing	No Small Groups
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Water Play	Free Play	Sand Play	Water Play	Free Play
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.45 – 14.15	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can't sleep may "read" books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children's books related to the topic.				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				

Activities with Parents throughout the day	- Parents can volunteer in Small Group activities - Parents can join in songs, games, books, storytelling - Parents can learn an activity and practice at home
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A. IDEAS FOR THE MORNING MEETING



Keeping Clean and Healthy

Children should be taught the importance of personal hygiene as early as possible. Hair care, toilet hygiene, and oral hygiene should be taught as part of everyday routines.

Objectives: To help children understand the importance of keeping their bodies clean and healthy.

Materials needed:

- Poster or drawing of children washing themselves
- Things used for keeping clean, e.g. soap, nail brush, sponge, Wash cloth or sponge, towel, tooth brush, tooth paste
- Comb and hair brush
- Bucket with water

Instructions:

1. Hold up the things used for keeping clean and ask the children what they are and what they are used for. Demonstrate how unfamiliar things are used. Let the children taste the tooth paste (even if they do not have tooth paste, they can learn what it is used for).
2. Use the poster to illustrate some of the ways we keep our bodies clean.
3. You can use following questions to encourage children to talk about keeping clean:
 - *What do we wash our bodies with? How do we wash our faces? Our ears? Our hands? Our hair? Our teeth?*
 - *How do we keep our hair neat?*
 - *How do we keep our noses clean?*
 - *Why do we wash?*
 - *When do we wash our hands?*
 - *How do you feel when you are clean?*



Hand Washing*

Objectives:

- Children will understand the importance of washing their hands to prevent illnesses.
- Children will practice washing their hands before preparing or eating food.

Materials needed:

- A medium size plastic bowl
- Soap
- Water
- Towel

Instructions:

1. Explain to the children that it is very important to have clean hands before eating or preparing food. Tell the children about how germs can travel from dirty hands to food and to people. Explain that people can get sick from germs that can be on dirty hands.
2. Demonstrate the correct way to wash your hands. Emphasize:
 - Using soap and warm water to produce bubbles
 - Washing the palms and backs of the hands
 - Washing between the fingers
 - Washing all the fingers
 - Rinsing off all the soap
 - Drying hands completely
3. Have children practice washing their hands.
4. Make up a song or chant to use when washing hands.
5. Discuss how animals clean or wash themselves and their foods.
6. Once the children get hand washing, you can discuss and demonstrate food washing, and or dish washing.
7. Discuss with parents the process used to wash hands and have them emphasize it at home.
8. Have dishwashing pans and soap in the housekeeping area so children can wash dolls dishes, hands etc.

*Note to teacher: When there is no running water, please use a cup to pour water on child's hands to wet, then they use soap, and then another cup is poured on their hands to rinse. Each child should bring a towel or washcloth from home that they can identify. Using the same wash water to wash hands is not clean and can spread germs.



Brushing Teeth*

Objective: Children will know how to brush their teeth correctly.

Materials needed:

- Egg boxes
- Small sticks
- White paint (if available) or chalk
- Sweet packets, wrappers, sugar (packet), fizzy drink

Preparation:

Paint the outside of the egg-shaped parts of the boxes with the white paint or chalk to look like teeth (or paste white paper on). Paint the lid red to look like the gums and inside of the mouth. Try to make enough to have one box per one or two children.

Instructions:

1. Ask the children, “why it is important to have good teeth.” You can say, “Apart from needing teeth to chew our food, bad teeth can make us sick.”
2. Tell the children a short story about plaque, which is a sticky layer of germs that grow on our teeth and gums. Plaque loves sweets, sugar and fizzy drinks. Plaque uses sugar to make holes in our teeth and damage gums. The one thing plaque hates is a toothbrush because it brushes it off our teeth and gums. “When sugar sticks to teeth, tiny sugar bugs form and eat away at the teeth, leaving small brown holes called cavities. The cavities are unhealthy and painful.” “ The best way to get rid of sugar bugs is to brush them and the excess sugar away.”
3. Give each child an egg box and small stick. Show the children the correct way to brush their teeth using round circular movements, in front, at the back and both sides, top and bottom teeth.
4. While brushing the teeth boxes sing a song, e.g. This is the way we brush our teeth, brush our teeth, brush our teeth, this is the way we brush our teeth, early in the morning.
 - Talk to the children about when to brush their teeth (after meals)

*Note to teacher: When possible, bring in Intersectorial Health team to support you in this activity.



Being Sick and Well Being...

Objective: Children will understand that they are given vaccinations to prevent them from getting sick.
Children will talk about what's it's like to be sick.

Materials needed:

- Paper
- Pencils, crayons and materials

Instructions:

1. Discuss immunizations with the children and explain that they prevent disease. Even if the vaccination hurts, it is not as bad as getting very ill with a disease.
 - *Have you ever gotten a vaccine?*
 - *What do you remember about it?*
2. Encourage children (one by one) to tell stories about when they got immunizations. Write down everything they say to share later with parents.
3. It might add to the experience to invite the school doctor or nurse to visit the class and talk about how immunizations help keep the children free from disease.
4. Place a doctor kit, bandages, band aids etc in the Drama Activity Center for children to use to act out vaccination and visiting the doctor. Sickness and illness are concerns for all children. Developing a box of materials to make a hospital corner during the year can be very helpful for children. If there is a child who is sick or parents who are ill, a hospital corner can help children learn about procedures and talk about their fears.
5. Read or develop books about what it's like to be sick. Discuss how it feels to be sick and what children should do if they feel sick.
6. Books about illness, hospitals, new siblings, death, and shots add to the experience.



Exercise Is Healthy

Objective: Children will become aware of the benefits of exercise.

Materials needed:

- Poster of a body/skeleton

Preparation:

1. Ask community members and parents tell about exercise facilities in the area or about people who exercise regularly or who are star athletes. Invite these people to come and visit the classroom.
2. Find pictures of athletes (both male and female) to put on the walls.

Instructions:

1. Talk about exercise and tell the children that their muscles (have them feel) and their hearts are made strong by continuous exercise (running, walking, biking, and dancing). Show pictures of the muscles and body skeleton, if available.
2. Have children run or dance for a few minutes and then feel their heart. Explain that their heart beats faster and gets stronger when they exercise. When the community health helpers visit, ask them to talk about the benefits of exercise with children.
3. If a guest has been invited, have them talk about their sport and talk about exercise and why it's good.
4. If there are any athletic facilities in the community, go on a field trip. Let the children try out the equipment, if appropriate.
5. Encourage children to exercise regularly



What Goes in My Mouth

Objective: Children will be able to identify items that are safe or not safe to put in their mouths.

Materials needed:

- Paper
- Markers
- Pen
- Tape

Instructions:

1. Young children learn through their senses. It is very important that they understand what they can safely put in their mouths (food and non-food items).
2. Ask the children if they know what the word poison means. Write down what the children say. Make a list.
3. After discussing what poisons are, with a small group of children look in the room or building for containers that may contain poison. When it is decided that a container is hazardous, draw a frowning face or a skull and crossbones on it. If there is a sign or symbol used in your country to indicate poison or hazardous material, use that. Children should be reminded that whenever a hazardous material is found, it should be given to an adult immediately to be stored or locked up.

Advanced: Have the children draw pictures of poisonous things and a skull and crossbones and post their pictures around the room.

B. IDEAS FOR THE SMALL GROUP ACTIVITIES



Hand Washing

Objectives: Children will develop their creativity by making pictures.

Materials needed:

- Crayons
- Paper

Instructions:

Beginner	Intermediate	Advanced
1. Ask children to draw a picture of the first thing they should do before preparing or eating food. The children can trace around their hands and draw soap bubbles. 2. Pictures can be placed on the wall as a reminder of instruction card for other children.	1. Ask children to draw a picture of the first thing they should do before preparing or eating food. The children can trace around their hands and draw soap bubbles. 2. Pictures can be placed on the wall as a reminder of instruction card for other children. 3. Ask children to draw pictures of the germs and to come up with stories about them. 4. Let children write or dictate the stories to you or to parents to write them down.	1. Ask children to draw a picture of the first thing they should do before preparing or eating food. The children can trace around their hands and draw soap bubbles. 2. Pictures can be placed on the wall as a reminder of instruction card for other children. 3. Ask children to draw pictures of the germs and to come up with stories about them. 4. Let children write or dictate the stories to you or to parents to write them down.



Nose Blowing

Objectives: Children will learn how to blow their nose.

Materials needed:

- Collect or buy materials - straws, whistles, tissues. For straws use paw paw leaves stems.

Instructions:

1. Some young children may not know how to blow their noses. Show children how to blow their nose and have them practice using a tissue. Explain that they should not blow their nose too hard because it can cause problems with their ears. For older children, have pictures of inside of the face and show how the nose and ears passages are related.
2. To have children experience what blowing means try a few of the following activities:
 - Have children practice blowing whistles - make a game out of it.
 - Have children use 4 straws to blow soapy water (be sure the children know the difference between blowing and sucking).
 - Have children draw pictures about how it feels to have a cold and need to blow their noses. Review the proper way to blow their nose and why it is important to wash their hands after blowing their noses.
 - Use this activity in conjunction with other health related activities. Always have tissues and waste baskets available. Discuss the activities with parents and invite doctors or nurses to class to further discuss germs, colds, and general health care.



Being Sick and Being Well

Objectives:

- Children will understand that they are given vaccinations to prevent them from getting sick.
- Children will talk about what's it's like to be sick.

Materials needed:

- Paper
- Pencil
- Crayons
- Markers

Instructions:

1. Ask the children to draw a picture about the stories when they got immunization.
2. Display the pictures and stories (written during the Morning Meeting) in the classroom and send them home to parents.
3. If there are children who are sick make other children to make the get well cards and to send them.



What Goes in My Mouth

Objectives: Children will be able to identify items that are safe or not safe to put in their mouths.

Materials needed:

- Paper
- Markers
- Tape

Instructions:

Beginner	Intermediate	Advanced
1. Collect food and non-food (not poisonous) items and have the children sort them into “Things That Can Go in My Mouth” and “Things That Must Not Go in My Mouth.” (Blocks, safety pins, buttons, small toys, and coins. This same activity can be done with pictures of poisonous and non-poisonous items. 2. Make charts and graphs to record findings and ideas. 3. Make up or read stories to children for them to solve. Ask how they would decide if a berry or nut was good to eat. This is a good time to talk about how sick poisons can make you. 4. These activities can be extensions of the activity about spreading germs and why hands and toys get washed	1. Collect food and non-food (not poisonous) items and have the children sort them into “Things That Can Go in My Mouth” and “Things That Must Not Go in My Mouth.” (Blocks, safety pins, buttons, small toys, and coins. This same activity can be done with pictures of poisonous and non-poisonous items. 2. Make charts and graphs to record findings and ideas. 3. Make up or read stories to children for them to solve. Ask how they would decide if a berry or nut was good to eat. This is a good time to talk about how sick poisons can make you. 4. Have children draw pictures of things that are poison or things they can and cannot put in their mouths. 5. These activities can be extensions of the activity about spreading germs and why hands and toys get washed.	1. Put each child’s name and date on the dull side of wet-glazed paper – finger painting can also be done on a plastic-topped table. 2. Press out the wrinkles before a child begins. 3. Tell children they can use their fingers, hands, and fists – no brushes! 4. Allow children to combine two colors and talk about the new color them made from two colors.

C. IDEAS FOR OUTDOOR GAMES



- Go for a walk, read books or discuss what animals eat. Talk with the children about the types of food animals eat and why or why not people can eat what animals eat. For example, rabbits eat carrots and so do humans. Cats eat mice and humans should not eat them.
- Take a trip to a food market or grocery store and have the children take a survey, make a list, or draw pictures of items that they should and should not put in their mouths, reinforce the ideas that the “bad for you” items should be out of the way or locked up at home.
- Take a walk outside or to a nursery or flower shop or exercise facility. Ask the workers to talk to the children about what plants are poisonous.



II: CARING FOR OUR COMMUNITY

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

Young children are very aware of their surroundings. They are beginning to feel that they are part of a bigger world. All of a sudden besides their home and family, they are part of a classroom and a school. They take field trips to community places and feel very proud that they know their way around.

Building a sense of community is very important for them. Educators need to teach young children that everyone has a responsibility to keep their communities safe and healthy for everyone.

As children begin to understand that they live in a community, they need to know that they have a responsibility for caring for each other, the land and the buildings. They need to know the people in the community that can help them and where to go if they need help.

Activities in this section introduce the idea of taking care of and understanding their community. The classroom is a community and activities include developing classroom rules so everyone can live safely in the community. This helps young children begin to understand the need for rules and how they are developed.

The larger community is also important in children's life. Activities on road signs and signals help children understand the rules of the community that make them safe. Meeting members of the community who help keeps it safe are critical. Knowing how and where to find help gives children a sense of control over their environment.

Just as children are learning to respect and take care of their bodies, young children need to begin to respect the earth and the gifts the earth gives to us. The activities in this section begin to help children respect their environment and keep their communities clean.

Children learn about taking care of the environment from the adults. Teachers who pick up trash, reuse materials, turn off lights and water are showing respect for the environment.

Activities in this section also focus on reusing materials, simple composting, and concrete examples of materials that are biodegradable.

Building a safe and respectful community within the classroom teaches children how to live in the bigger world. They can try out new skills in dramatic play, explore roles of community members, and learn about cleaning the environment and taking care of one another. These activities can be expanded and extended.





WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – December, Week 3

II: Caring for Our Community

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Topic: “Knowing Our Community”	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Reasons for Classroom Rules	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • What is the topic for the week? • Reusing Materials	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • What is the topic for the week? • Keeping Our Community Clean	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • What is the topic for the week? • Talk about Community Walk
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child’s choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups	Community Group Painting	Reusing Materials	Making Collages	Sorting Materials	No Small Groups
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Trash Walk	Free Play	Trash Walk	Sorting Outside	Free Play
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.45 – 14.15	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can’t sleep may “read” books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children’s books related to the topic.				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				
Activities with Parents throughout the day		• Parents can volunteer in Small Group activities • Parents can join in songs, games, books, storytelling • Parents can accompany class on trash walk				



A. IDEAS FOR THE MORNING MEETING



Knowing Our Community

Objectives:

- To increase children's knowledge of the community in which they live.
- To help children learn new words and develop their thinking and language skills.

Instructions:

1. Ask children to recall any stories about when they visited other buildings different than their homes – the examples might be the market, the hospital, etc. Explain to the children what a community is.
2. Ask children what they saw there and what they did there, who were the people there and what those people did.
3. Tell children that in addition to their homes there are other building in the community where people provide different services to the people and children in the community – like school, hospital, church, market, etc.
4. Show pictures if possible or organize the trip.

Advanced: Have children generate the names of places that make up their community.



Classroom Rules

Objective: Children will review the classroom rules and know the reasons for the rules.

Note: Classroom Rules activity has been conducted already during the first week of September, however it is important to review the Classroom Rules from time to time and to see which of them are still valid and which of them not. It also gives children the understanding the Classroom Rules can change depending on the nature of the classroom community.

Instructions:

1. Ask the children why there are rules, why they are important, and how they can promote safety. Ask the children about what rules are needed in their classroom to make sure that the classroom is a safe place for children and families.
2. Together with the children review the existing rules to check whether you need the new ones and whether the existing ones are still valid. There should be only 3-5 general rules for the classroom. There may be more specific rules for certain activity areas or activities. General classroom rules usually address the overall well being of the group (respecting others, movement and safety, talking and listening, and protecting materials and possessions.
3. Once you and the children review the rules, write the rules in big letters and illustrate the rules. Use positive instead of negative words. For example say, “We use our indoor voices in the classroom” instead of saying, “no yelling or shouting in the classroom.”



Visit to the Primary School

If possible, children can also be taken on other visits (e.g. hospital, market, etc.), which they can talk about before and afterwards in group time.

Objective: To prepare children for primary school and build links between ECD program and the school.

Preparation:

1. The day before the visit, during Morning Meeting, talk to the children about the visit and what they might see there. Show them pictures or real things they might see there – e.g. pencil, ruler, exercise book etc. in the primary school.
2. Ask children what they think happens at the school and what they might see. Tell children the names of the people they will meet and expected behavior. Talk about the uniform children wear at the school. After the visit to the primary school during Group Time, ask questions to help children talk about what they did and saw during their visit. Clarify any misunderstandings.
3. Following questions might help you to lead the discussion:
 - *What uniform do children wear? What color is it? Do boys and girls wear the same clothes? What is the same and what is different?*
 - *What do they carry in their cases?*
 - *How many rooms are at the school? What happened in different rooms?*
 - *What do children write with? What do people write? Why? What is reading? What do people read?*
 - *What are children reading?*



Keeping Our Community Clean

Objective: Children will learn that keeping the classroom community and larger community clean is everyone's responsibility.

Materials needed: None

Background Information:

While adults have the most responsibility for keeping the community and classroom clean, children can help. Modeling the behavior you want from children makes a big impact on children. Try and find safe ways each day that the children can take care of their classroom and larger community.

Instructions:

1. Discuss with the children the importance of their participation in the cleaning up their classroom as much as possible. Washing tables and floors, putting away dishes, scraping food off their plates, cleaning up after art activities all give them the experience of keeping their classroom community clean.
2. Discuss with the children what could be done with old toys that are still in good and safe condition (give them to children who may need them, trade with another classroom, give them to a family who's house burned down etc.)
3. Lists, charts, graphs, pictures and stories can be created from the children's ideas.
4. If a trash collector comes to pick up trash at the school, allow the children to watch how the trash is picked up. If possible ask the workers to come to class and talk about ways to reduce trash and where the trash goes.
5. Talk with parents about giving the children cleaning and pick-up responsibilities at home.
6. Have a designated "Cleaning Day." Ask children to wear old clothes and give children duties. Sorting puzzles, putting all the beads in the proper place, washing the sand table, giving the dolls a bath, sweeping the floor. After the jobs are done, have a celebration and enjoy how it feels to have a clean and neat environment.
7. Have a designated time each week to inspect toys, sort ones that may be unsafe or broken. Children can help. Work with the children to fix broken toys. Invite parents to help fixing toys.



Reusing Materials

Objective: As children become aware of their environment and their community, it is critical that they begin to think about reusing or recycling materials. (Children will learn the importance of reusing and recycling materials)

Preparation:

1. Before introducing the idea of recycling, the teacher should research the community recycling opportunities and discover what is happening in the community to help keep the environment clean.

Instructions:

1. At this age, children will learn the most about recycling, keeping things neat and reusing materials by the way the adults model the behavior. Reuse as many materials as possible. Show the children how things are reused and recycled every day.
2. Have the children begin collecting materials that can be reused or recycled. Sort the materials and discuss how they can be recycled or ways they can be reused. Use as many reusable materials in the classroom as possible. Allow the children to use their creativity.
3. Discuss with the children the idea that some materials go back into the soil while others just pile up. Have them draw pictures or make up stories about what will happen if these items keep piling up and piling up.
4. Recycling may be a new idea in some places. If there are no places to recycle, concentrate on ways to keep the community clean. Have children pick up trash, talk to the community about putting in more trash cans, sponsor a "clean up our school" day and invite parents and community members.
5. Invite various city workers to the classroom to talk about what they do- collect trash, recycle bottles, clean the streets, plant flowers in the parks etc.
6. Have children talk with their parents about things that get reused in their house (rags may be turned in rugs etc.) Ask parents to come to class and show how things can be reused or repaired.
7. Do a survey of the classroom. Decide what is reused and what is not. Ask the children if they can think of ways to reuse things they throw away.
8. Create charts and graphs so children can visual see how many things can be reused or thrown away. Keep a weekly chart of how much trash is thrown away.



Recycling Garbage to Produce Compost

Objective: Children will understand the idea what types of materials can go back into the earth (biodegradable) and what types of materials do not.

Materials needed:

- A plastic bag for each child
- Soil
- Grass clippings
- Assorted vegetable and fruit scraps (apple peels, carrot tops and peelings, potato skins, banana peels)
- A collection of things that will not biodegrade quickly (plastic, bottle tops, glass, wood) clean soil
- Water

Instructions:

1. Discuss with the children the process of change. Help them separate a collection of items into things that they predict:
 - will change
 - may or may not change
 - will never change
2. Have each child fill a plastic baggie with the following materials:
 - 1/2 cup soil
 - 1 large spoonful of grass clippings
 - 1 cup assorted vegetable and fruit scraps. The scraps should be fresh and not moldy. Children should tear scraps into small pieces.
 - 40-45 milliliters of water (enough to moisten the mixture, but not saturate)
3. Once the bag is closed tell the children to gently manipulate the baggie to mix these ingredients. Set the baggies into a box, or hang a clothes line in the classroom and clip the bags to it. For comparison, prepare baggies containing the same ingredients except substitute things that are not organic matter (plastic, Styrofoam) in place of the fruit and vegetable scraps.
4. Children should squeeze the baggies each day to mix the contents. Every other day open the baggies for a day. If the contents smell, there is too much water or the contents need more air or mixing.

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5. Predict what will happen to each of the different scraps in the baggies. Younger children enjoy drawing what the scraps might look like in four to six weeks.
6. Once the decomposition is complete, have the children plant a seed in their rich soil.
7. Make chart to record what happens to the different items. Go back to the children's predictions and record what happened to each item.
8. Discuss all the items used and which ones broke down and turned into soil; which ones broke down a little; and which ones did not break down at all. Depending on the community, visit a recycling center or other community agency working on recycling.

B. IDEAS FOR THE SMALL GROUP ACTIVITIES



Community Group Painting*

Objective:

- To encourage children to use their creative and memory skills.
- To give children a better understanding of the community they live in.
- To help children develop their cooperative skills

Materials needed:

- Large sheets of paper
- Paste or sticky tape
- Crayons

Preparation:

1. Stick the pieces of paper next to each other on an empty space on the walls of the playroom at the children's eye-level.
2. Draw a road or street running from one end of the paper to the other, and one or two roads/streets crossing it.

Instructions:

1. Suggest to the children that they draw a big picture of the community in which they live.
2. Talk to the children about what is in the community. Brainstorm a list of buildings then ask who want to draw each one.
3. Encourage children to work together – one or two children can work together drawing the school, another children can color the drawings, etc.

*See Teacher Planner: My Neighborhood



Street Signs and Signals

Objectives:

- Children will be able to identify and obey street signs and signals.
- Children will know the difference between red, green and yellow lights and other signs

Materials needed:

- Cardboard
- Markers
- Colored construction paper or painted paper
- Tape
- Construction paper or painted paper

Preparation:

1. Cut out a rectangular piece of cardboard.
2. Draw three circles on the cardboard and either glue colored paper to the circles or draw/paint on the cardboard (1 red, 1 yellow, 1 green.)

Instructions:

1. Explain to the children that traffic signals make the street safe for everyone: pedestrians, bicyclists and automobiles.
2. Explain the meaning of the different color lights: red = stop, green = go and yellow = wait. Discuss with the children what to do if they are already in the street when the light turns yellow.
3. Make a sample traffic light and let the children practice in the classroom.

Advanced: Develop a game. Play music and when the leader shows the stop sign or red light, the children stop, green they go and yellow they slow down or wait. Do the same with pedestrian or other safety signs used in your community.

For children living in urban areas - take the children for a walk. Look for traffic signals. Review the proper way to cross the street, and practice with the children.

For children living in rural areas – use color paper for different traffic lights and make children move accordingly to the “lights”.

Additional Information:

- It can be helpful to let parents know that traffic safety is being discussed in class, so that they can reinforce the concepts at home.
- Tell the parents that you are talking about streets signs and safety. Give them ideas on how to reinforce the information at home. Have parents participate in activities in the classroom or during parent meetings.

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- Children can make a collage or painting with the traffic light colors. The traffic light and signs can stay in the block area can be used in gross motor play.
- Traffic signs can be added to the collection and used outside with the bikes and wagons or in the block area. Invite a traffic officer to come and talk with the children about street safety, riding bikes and other safety concerns. Add trucks and cars to the block area. The children can build roads, bridges and towns and practice with the vehicles.



Keeping Our Community Clean: Sorting Game

Objective:

- Children will understand that keeping the classroom community and larger community clean is everyone's responsibility.
- Children will develop their cognitive skills in sorting different materials.

Preparation:

Collect different things from home and the classroom.

Instructions:

1. Ask children to sort the things collected from home and the classroom into various categories. Categories could include "Things that are safe to pick up on the street" and "Things that are not safe to pick up on the street."
2. Talk to the children about unsafe materials and what they should do about them. This is also a good opportunity to reinforce your lesson about germs and hand washing!
3. Other categories might include "Things that can be reused." and "Things that need to be thrown away." Have children brainstorm how many ways to reuse things. This teaches them in a concrete way about recycling and using things again. Another category for older children may be "Things that go back into the earth" and "Things that do not go back into the earth for a very long time."



Reusing Materials

Objectives:

As children become aware of their environment and their community, it is critical that they begin to think about reusing or recycling materials. Children will learn the importance of reusing and recycling materials.

Instructions:

1. Have the children begin collecting materials that can be reused or recycled. Sort the materials and discuss how they can be recycled or ways they can be reused. Use as many reusable materials in the classroom as possible. Allow the children to use their creativity.
2. Make collages out of trash.
3. Play a game with items collected in the classroom. Sort into things that can be reused and things to throw away.

C. IDEAS FOR OUTDOOR ACTIVITIES

- Go for a “Trash Walk” and look for areas or items that need to be picked up. This takes adult supervision so that children do not pick up unsafe materials. Discuss with the children what should be done with candy wrappers and soda bottles and other trash found on the walk.
- If a trash collector comes to pick up trash at the school, allow the children to watch how the trash is picked up. If possible as the workers to come to class and talk about ways to reduce trash and where the trash goes.
- Visit a recycling center if available